SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

16 October 2020 · Shift 2

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

In the sentence identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. I learnt to adapt quickly to new schools because we moved to new places quite frequent.

(A) I learnt to adapt quickly
(B) we moved to new places
(C) quite frequent
(D) to new schools

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. ROWDY

(A) Charming
(B) Boisterous
(C) Calm
(D) Amenable

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. BARREN

(A) Fertile
(B) Bountiful
(C) Desolate
(D) Fruitful

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Once in a blue moon

(A) An incident that is scary
(B) Happening only once in a lifetime
(C) Happening only rarely
(D) An unforgettable experience

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. To close the day on a high note, we decided to spend the rest of (1)_____ evening at a 100-year-old historic watering hole in downtown Juneau. We wanted to (2)_____ our bear sightings and how it feels to be in the wild. While raising a toast and reminiscing (3)_____ our time in the woods, I felt a deeper connection with nature. It was a (4)_____ experience to walk for miles with no particular reason or intention other than absorbing (5)_____ solitude of the jungle, open to the sky.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 1.

(A) their
(B) ours
(C) our
(D) theirs

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. To close the day on a high note, we decided to spend the rest of (1)_____ evening at a 100-year-old historic watering hole in downtown Juneau. We wanted to (2)_____ our bear sightings and how it feels to be in the wild. While raising a toast and reminiscing (3)_____ our time in the woods, I felt a deeper connection with nature. It was a (4)_____ experience to walk for miles with no particular reason or intention other than absorbing (5)_____ solitude of the jungle, open to the sky.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 2.

(A) celebrated
(B) celebration
(C) celebrate
(D) celebrates

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. To close the day on a high note, we decided to spend the rest of (1)_____ evening at a 100-year-old historic watering hole in downtown Juneau. We wanted to (2)_____ our bear sightings and how it feels to be in the wild. While raising a toast and reminiscing (3)_____ our time in the woods, I felt a deeper connection with nature. It was a (4)_____ experience to walk for miles with no particular reason or intention other than absorbing (5)_____ solitude of the jungle, open to the sky.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 3.

(A) for
(B) in
(C) with
(D) about

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. To close the day on a high note, we decided to spend the rest of (1)_____ evening at a 100-year-old historic watering hole in downtown Juneau. We wanted to (2)_____ our bear sightings and how it feels to be in the wild. While raising a toast and reminiscing (3)_____ our time in the woods, I felt a deeper connection with nature. It was a (4)_____ experience to walk for miles with no particular reason or intention other than absorbing (5)_____ solitude of the jungle, open to the sky.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 4.

(A) profound
(B) sincere
(C) comical
(D) dismal

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. To close the day on a high note, we decided to spend the rest of (1)_____ evening at a 100-year-old historic watering hole in downtown Juneau. We wanted to (2)_____ our bear sightings and how it feels to be in the wild. While raising a toast and reminiscing (3)_____ our time in the woods, I felt a deeper connection with nature. It was a (4)_____ experience to walk for miles with no particular reason or intention other than absorbing (5)_____ solitude of the jungle, open to the sky.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 5.

(A) some
(B) the
(C) a
(D) much

Q.10

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Some such common events that bring us happiness for a short time include passing an exam, getting a job, going on a vacation or buying a dream house. B. Happiness is more difficult to achieve than peace as we keep striving for it daily. C. Peace, on the other hand, is sustainable for many years, costs less energy, and doesn't depend on external events such as these. D. Events that we struggle for in our daily lives to bring us happiness only come randomly, stay for a short time and subside.

(A) BDAC
(B) ACDB
(C) BCAD
(D) BACD

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. We've had a long day. We should rest now, "shouldn't we?"

(A) hadn't we
(B) haven't we
(C) No improvement
(D) won't we

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Balloon
(B) Adulteration
(C) Irritant
(D) Bunglow

Q.14

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Roopa said to me, "Please accompany me to the market."

(A) Roopa said please accompany me to the market.
(B) Roopa said to me that you must accompany me to the market.
(C) Roopa requested me to accompany her to the market.
(D) Roopa is requesting me to accompany her to the market.

Q.15

Select the word which means the same as the given group of words. Arrangement of events or dates in the order in which they happen

(A) Geology
(B) Chronology
(C) Archaeology
(D) Ecology

Q.16

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. There was a range of _____ that kept tourists engaged during the International Film Festival in Goa.

(A) moments
(B) conversions
(C) employments
(D) activities

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. CONCEALED

(A) Masked
(B) Revealed
(C) Discussed
(D) Hidden

Q.18

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. We are arranging an exhibition of sarees from different states of India at Dilli Haat.

(A) An exhibition of sarees from different states of India is being arranged by us at Dilli Haat.

(B) An exhibition of sarees from different states of India was arranged by us at Dilli Haat.

(C) An exhibition of sarees from different states of India has been arranged by us at Dilli Haat.

(D) An exhibition of sarees from different states of India will be arranged by us at Dilli Haat.

Q.19

In the sentence identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. The environment protection policy need to become stricter if we wish to combat climate change.

(A) The environment protection policy

(B) need to become stricter

(C) combat climate change

(D) if we wish to

Q.20

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. He flew down, searched for her until he found her and then asked her to become his wife. B. A hawk flying about in the sky one day decided that he would like to marry a hen whom he often saw on earth. C. The hawk was delighted and flew away after giving her a ring as an engagement present, and telling her to take good care of it. D. She at once gave her consent on the condition that he would wait until she could grow wings like his, so that she might also fly high.

(A) BDCA

(B) BCDA

(C) BADC

(D) ADCB

Q.21

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. I had a stroke at an early age, but what I thought was a great _____ at that time changed my life for the better.

(A) lowliness

(B) significance

(C) setback

(D) moodiness

Q.22

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. ADMONISH

(A) Applaud

(B) Belittle

(C) Harden

(D) Attack

Q.23

Select the word which means the same as the given group of words. Someone who freely gives money and help to people who need it

(A) Philologist

(B) Philanthropist

(C) Impressionist

(D) Receptionist

Q.24

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. Rohit Sharma "have declared" the best batsman of 2019.

(A) had declared

(B) has been declared

(C) No improvement

(D) is declaring

Q.25

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To leave someone in the lurch.

(A) To put someone at ease

(B) To come to compromise with someone

(C) Constant source of annoyance to someone

(D) To desert someone in his difficulties

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which Indian cricketer has scored the most number of runs in a single World Cup?

(A) Kapil Dev
(B) Rohit Sharma
(C) Rahul Dravid
(D) Sachin Tendulkar

Q.2

Who wrote 'Humayun Nama'?

(A) Akbar
(B) Babur
(C) Humayun
(D) Gulbadan Begum

Q.3

Which of the following symbols must be used before a formula in a Microsoft Excel sheet?

(A) =
(B) &
(C) $
(D) @

Q.4

How many Indian bowlers have taken a hat-trick in International test cricket?

(A) Four
(B) Two
(C) One
(D) Three

Q.5

The moon is an example of a _____ object.

(A) transparent
(B) translucent
(C) luminous
(D) non-luminous

Q.6

When was the PIN Code (Postal Index Code) introduced in India?

(A) 1949
(B) 1969
(C) 1972
(D) 1963

Q.7

Which of the following oil companies started an LPG bottling plant in Balangir district of Odisha in December 2019?

(A) Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited
(B) Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited
(C) Reliance Industries Limited
(D) Indian Oil Corporation Limited

Q.8

Which article in the Constitution of India empowers the President of India to promulgate ordinances when the Parliament is in recess?

(A) Article 232
(B) Article 312
(C) Article 123
(D) Article 213

Q.9

As of February 2020, who is the Governor of Goa?

(A) Satyapal Malik
(B) Pramod Sawant
(C) Bhagat Singh Koshyari
(D) Shripad Yesso Naik

Q.10
In which of the following cities was the 'India International Science Festival (IISF)' held in November 2019?

(A) Bengaluru
(B) Kolkata
(C) New Delhi
(D) Thiruvananthapuram

Q.11
'Income and employment theory' is the other name for which branch of Economics?

(A) International economics
(B) Public finance
(C) Microeconomics
(D) Macroeconomics

Q.12
According to a report released by Greenpeace in Aug, 2019, India is the highest emitter of which of the following pollutants (gases)?

(A) Carbon Monoxide
(B) Sulphur dioxide
(C) Ammonia
(D) Nitrogen dioxide

Q.13
The solar tracking (moving in the sun's direction) of the sunflower is called _____.

(A) Phototropism
(B) Thigmotropism
(C) Heliotropism
(D) Hydrotropism

Q.14
What is the full form of BASIC in context of the BASIC computer language?

(A) Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Input Code
(B) Beginner's All-purpose Systematic Instruction Code
(C) Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Input-output Code
(D) Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Instruction Code

Q.15
Who is the author of the book 'Bridgital Nation – Solving Technology's People Problem'?

(A) Nandan Nilekani
(B) Ratan Tata
(C) N Chandrasekaran
(D) Narayanamurthy

Q.16
Slate is a type of _____ rock.

(A) metamorphic
(B) sedimentary
(C) igneous
(D) volcanic

Q.17
Who among the following is/was a famous Tabla player?

(A) TN Krishnan
(B) Bhimsen Joshi
(C) Alla Rakha
(D) Hariprasad Chaurasia

Q.18
How many fundamental duties are set out in Part IV A (Article 51A) of the Constitution of India?

(A) 9
(B) 11
(C) 10
(D) 12

Q.19
The process that moves, elevates or builds up portions of the earth's crust is called:

(A) denudation
(B) volcanism
(C) weathering
(D) diastrophism

Q.20

Who is the author of 'Malavikagnimitram'?

(A) Kalidasa
(B) Kautilya
(C) Vyasa
(D) Vagbhata

Q.21

Who is the only Indian to be nominated for the ‘IWGA Athlete of the Year 2019'?

(A) Mithali Singh
(B) Amiya Kumar Mallick
(C) Rani Rampal
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.22

Translated into English, the motto of the Indian National Army (INA) was _____.

(A) Do or Die
(B) Unity and Discipline
(C) Service before self
(D) Unity, Faith, Sacrifice

Q.23

Deficiency of thiamine results in _____.

(A) Rickets
(B) Pellagra
(C) Beriberi
(D) Scurvy

Q.24

River Sutlej enters India through which pass?

(A) Shipki la
(B) Lipulekh
(C) Zoji la
(D) Nathula

Q.25

'Matki' is a popular folk dance of which of the following states?

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Assam
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Bihar

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (C) quite frequent

The verb 'moved' needs an adverb, not the adjective 'frequent': 'we moved to new places quite frequently'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Boisterous

'Rowdy' means noisy and disorderly: 'boisterous'. 'Calm' and 'amenable' (easily persuaded) are nearly opposite, and 'charming' does not fit.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Desolate

'Barren' means bare and unable to support life or crops: 'desolate'. 'Fertile', 'bountiful' and 'fruitful' are its opposites.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Happening only rarely

'Once in a blue moon' means very rarely, not only once in a lifetime.

Q.5 · Answer (C) our

The writer speaks as 'we', so it is 'our' evening; the pronoun 'ours' cannot stand before a noun.

Q.6 · Answer (C) celebrate

'Wanted to' takes the base form of the verb: 'to celebrate our bear sightings'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) about

'Reminisce' takes 'about': to reminisce about something is to recall it with pleasure.

Q.8 · Answer (A) profound

Walking for miles, absorbing the solitude of the jungle and feeling a deeper connection with nature is a 'profound', deeply felt, experience. 'Sincere' describes people and feelings, and 'comical' and 'dismal' do not suit the passage.

Q.9 · Answer (B) the

The solitude is a particular one, defined by 'of the jungle', so it takes 'the'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) BDAC

B sets happiness against peace, D says the events that bring happiness come randomly and do not last, A gives examples of 'such' events, and C, opening 'Peace, on the other hand', closes the contrast: BDAC.

Q.11 · Answer (C) No improvement

A positive statement with 'should' takes a negative tag with the same auxiliary and subject: 'We should rest now, shouldn't we?' The sentence is correct as it stands.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Bunglow

The correct spelling is 'bungalow'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Roopa requested me to accompany her to the market.

A request with 'Please' is reported with 'requested', the imperative becomes 'to' + verb, and Roopa's 'me' becomes 'her': 'Roopa requested me to accompany her to the market.'

Q.15 · Answer (B) Chronology

Chronology is the arrangement of events or dates in the order in which they happened. Geology studies the earth's rocks, archaeology the human past through its remains, and ecology the relations of living things to their surroundings.

Q.16 · Answer (D) activities

Tourists are kept engaged by a range of 'activities', things to do; 'moments', 'conversions' and 'employments' do not fit.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Revealed

'Concealed' means hidden; its opposite is 'revealed'. 'Masked' and 'hidden' are synonyms.

Q.18 · Answer (A) An exhibition of sarees from different states of India is being arranged by us at Dilli Haat.
The present continuous 'are arranging' becomes 'is being arranged' in the passive, with the singular subject 'an exhibition of sarees'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) need to become stricter
The singular subject 'the environment protection policy' takes a singular verb: 'needs to become stricter'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) BADC
B introduces the hawk who wants to marry a hen, A tells how he flew down and proposed, D gives her condition that he wait until she grows wings, and C, the delighted hawk flying off after giving her a ring, follows: BADC.

Q.21 · Answer (C) setback
A stroke at an early age, which the speaker took for a misfortune at the time, is a 'setback'; 'but' sets it against the better life that followed.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Applaud
To 'admonish' is to scold or warn firmly; its opposite is to 'applaud', to praise. 'Belittle' and 'attack' are close to it in sense.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Philanthropist
A philanthropist freely gives money and help to those in need. A philologist studies the history of languages, and a receptionist greets visitors.

Q.24 · Answer (B) has been declared
Rohit Sharma was declared the best batsman by others, so the verb must be passive, and the singular subject takes 'has': 'Rohit Sharma has been declared the best batsman of 2019.'

Q.25 · Answer (D) To desert someone in his difficulties
To 'leave someone in the lurch' is to abandon them when they are in difficulty.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Sachin Tendulkar
When the exam was held, in October 2020, the Indian record for one World Cup was Sachin Tendulkar's 673 runs in 2003; Rohit Sharma made 648 in 2019. (Virat Kohli passed it with 765 runs in 2023.)

Q.2 · Answer (D) Gulbadan Begum
The 'Humayun Nama' was written by Gulbadan Begum, Babur's daughter and Humayun's half-sister, at Akbar's request.

Q.3 · Answer (A) =
Excel treats an entry that begins with '=' as a formula, for example =A1+B1; '$' marks an absolute reference inside a formula.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Three
When the exam was held, in October 2020, three Indians had taken a Test hat-trick: Harbhajan Singh (against Australia, 2001), Irfan Pathan (against Pakistan, 2006) and Jasprit Bumrah (against the West Indies, 2019).

Q.5 · Answer (D) non-luminous
The moon gives out no light of its own; it is seen by the sunlight it reflects, so it is non-luminous.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 1972
The six-digit Postal Index Number (PIN) code was introduced on 15 August 1972.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited
Bharat Petroleum's LPG bottling plant at Balangir, Odisha, was dedicated to the nation on 27 December 2019.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Article 123
Article 123 lets the President promulgate ordinances at any time except when both Houses of Parliament are in session; Article 213 gives a Governor the same power for a state.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Satyapal Malik
In February 2020 the Governor of Goa was Satya Pal Malik, who took office on 3 November 2019. Pramod Sawant was the state's Chief Minister and Bhagat Singh Koshyari the Governor of Maharashtra.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Kolkata
The fifth India International Science Festival was held in Kolkata from 5 to 8 November 2019.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Macroeconomics
Macroeconomics studies the economy as a whole, its total income, output and employment, and so is also called the theory of income and employment.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Sulphur dioxide
Greenpeace's August 2019 analysis of NASA satellite data found India the world's largest emitter of man-made sulphur dioxide, mostly from coal-burning power plants.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Heliotropism
Heliotropism is the movement of a plant part that follows the sun across the sky, as young sunflower heads do. Phototropism is growth towards light in general, thigmotropism a response to touch and hydrotropism to water.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Beginner’s All-purpose Symbolic Instruction Code
BASIC stands for Beginner's All-purpose Symbolic Instruction Code; John Kemeny and Thomas Kurtz designed it at Dartmouth College in 1964.

Q.15 · Answer (C) N Chandrasekaran
'Bridgital Nation' (2019) was written by N Chandrasekaran with Roopa Purushothaman.

Q.16 · Answer (A) metamorphic
Slate is a metamorphic rock, formed from shale under heat and pressure.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Alla Rakha
Ustad Alla Rakha was a tabla maestro, the father of Zakir Hussain. T N Krishnan is known for the violin, Bhimsen Joshi for Hindustani vocal music and Hariprasad Chaurasia for the bansuri.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 11
Article 51A lists 11 fundamental duties: the 42nd Amendment (1976) added ten, and the 86th Amendment (2002) the eleventh, on parents providing education for their children aged 6 to 14.

Q.19 · Answer (D) diastrophism
Diastrophism covers all the processes that move, elevate or build up portions of the earth's crust, such as folding and faulting. Denudation and weathering wear the surface down.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Kalidasa
'Malavikagnimitram', a Sanskrit play about the Shunga king Agnimitra and Malavika, is by Kalidasa.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Rani Rampal
Rani Rampal, India's women's hockey captain, was put forward by the International Hockey Federation and was the only Indian among the 25 athletes nominated for the World Games Athlete of the Year 2019; she won the public vote in January 2020.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Unity, Faith, Sacrifice
The INA's motto was 'Ittehad, Itmad aur Qurbani': Unity, Faith, Sacrifice. 'Do or Die' was Gandhi's call in the Quit India Movement, and 'Unity and Discipline' is the motto of the NCC.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Beriberi
Thiamine is vitamin B1, and its lack causes beriberi. Rickets comes from a lack of vitamin D, pellagra of niacin (B3) and scurvy of vitamin C.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Shipki la

The Sutlej, which rises near Lake Rakshastal in Tibet, enters India at Shipki La in the Kinnaur district of Himachal Pradesh.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Madhya Pradesh

Matki is a folk dance of the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh, performed by women balancing earthen pots (matkis) on their heads.

This paper online, with tap-to-reveal answers: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-chsl/question-papers/chsl-2019-tier-i-16-oct-2020-shift-2/
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